

HEAVY DEPLOYMENT
An Indian T90 Bhishma tank near the LAC in the Chumar-Demchok area of Eastern Ladakh

ANI

DESIRED CAPABILITIES OF THE LIGHT TANK

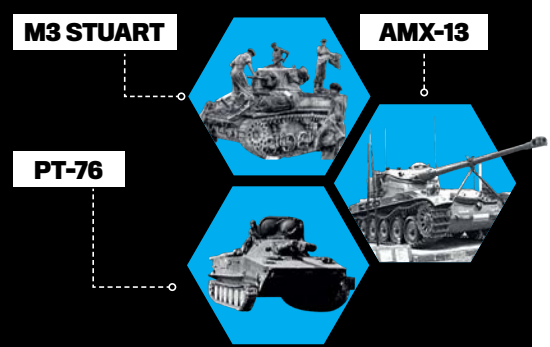
COMBAT WEIGHT
< 25 TONS

POWER TO WEIGHT RATIO
>25HP/TON

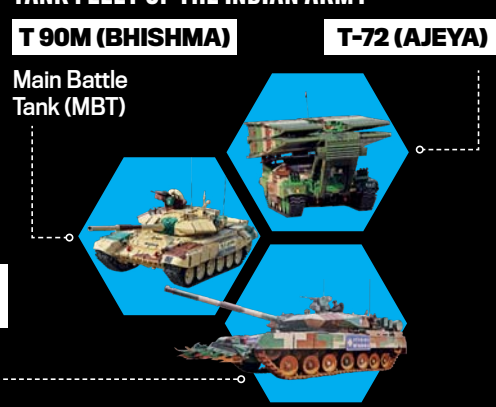
MOBILITY
AMPHIBIOUS (FOR MARSHY TERRAIN)

ARMAMENT
MAIN GUN < 105MM AND MISSILE FIRING

INDIAN ARMY'S PAST INVENTORY OF LIGHT TANKS



TANK FLEET OF THE INDIAN ARMY



the PLA across the LAC, the Indian army realised a light tank would best meet the need to counter the growing Chinese threat and have an effective fighting platform of its own. But the current world inventory for light tanks is very limited. Worse, the available options are not optimal for high altitudes.

Dhanoa points out that from the 1960s till the mid-1980s, India did have light tanks such as the AMX-13 and PT-76 in its arsenal. But an ageing light tank fleet, a fixation with the threat from the West and a desire to modernise as well as reduce/ do away with holdings of old equipment saw the Indian armour in the late 1980s and 1990s focus on only a few medium tanks such as the Vijayanta, T-55 and T-72. The army favoured main battle tanks (MBTs) while focusing on the plains of Punjab and deserts of Rajasthan as the theatres of decision in future wars. In the mid-1980s, the Defence Research and Development